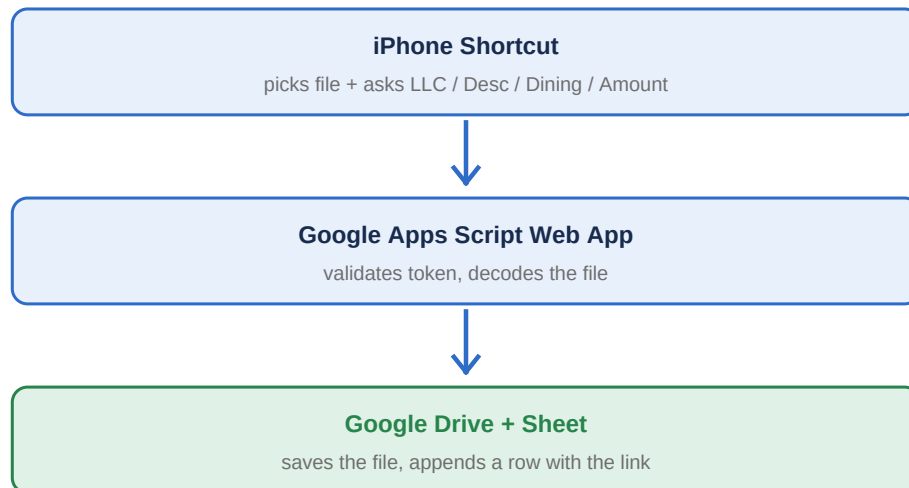


Receipt Logger

Building the "Log Receipt (Choose File)" Shortcut

A step-by-step guide to duplicate your camera shortcut and change it to pick an existing file (image or PDF) from the Files app or Photo Library.



TIP: Start from your **WORKING** camera shortcut. Duplicating it keeps all the JSON, token, and POST wiring correct - you only change where the file comes from.

What you will change (only 3 things):

- Swap 'Take Photo' for 'Select File'.
- Point 'Base64 Encode' at the picked file (not its name).
- Send the file type so PDFs stay PDFs (mimeType or a .pdf fileName).

Part 1 - Duplicate and swap the source

0 Duplicate the working shortcut

- Open the Shortcuts app.
- Long-press 'Log Receipt' -> Duplicate.
- Open the copy, tap its name, rename it to 'Log Receipt (Choose File)'.

1 Delete the camera action

- Find the 'Take Photo' action (the first action).
- Tap the X on it to delete it.

WATCH OUT: Deleting Take Photo orphans whatever used its output (Base64 Encode). You will re-link that in Step 3 - do not skip it.

2 Add the file picker

Where Take Photo used to be, add ONE of these:

- Select File - for PDFs and files from the Files app (best for receipts).
- Select Photos - for existing pictures in your Photo Library.

Set 'Select Multiple' to OFF (you want a single file).

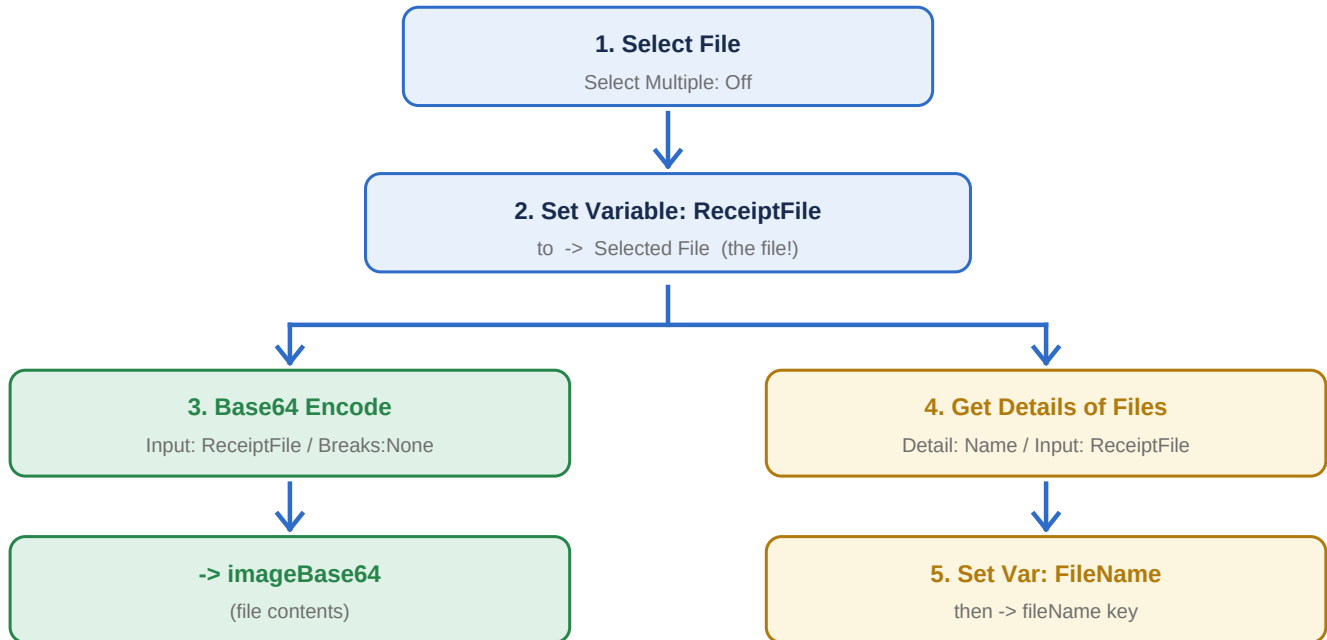
3 Re-point Base64 Encode (the critical relink)

Tap the Base64 Encode action's Input and set it to the picked file. Confirm 'Line Breaks: None'.

COMMON MISTAKE: Do NOT encode the file's Name. Encode the FILE ITSELF. Base64-encoding the filename produces garbage - the saved file will be broken.

Part 2 - The action flow (5 actions)

One 'Select File' feeds TWO separate branches. This is the #1 place people get confused, so here it is as a picture:



TIP: LEFT branch = the file's CONTENTS -> imageBase64. RIGHT branch = the file's NAME -> fileName. Two different outputs of the same Select File.

In the JSON body action, set the values to CHIPS (shaded capsules), not typed words:

- imageBase64 -> the 'Base64 Encoded' chip (from step 3)
- fileName -> the 'FileName' chip (from step 5)

Part 3 - The JSON body & making PDFs stay PDFs

6 What the JSON body should look like

In 'Get Contents of URL' -> Request Body: JSON, one field per key. Chips are shown here as shaded capsules; token/mimeType are typed text.

token	your-secret-token
llc	LLC
description	Description
dining	Dining
amount	Amount
imageBase64	Base64 Encoded
fileName	FileName
mimeType	application/pdf

TIP: The last line, mimeType = application/pdf, is the reliable fix for a PDF-only shortcut. It overrides everything, so files always save as .pdf.

7 Why a PDF was saving as .jpg (and how to fix it)

The server picks the file type in this order:

- 1. explicit 'mimeType' you send (wins)
- 2. a data-URI prefix on the base64 (iOS does not add this)
- 3. the extension in 'fileName' (e.g. ends in .pdf)
- 4. if none of the above: DEFAULT to JPEG -> your file becomes .jpg

COMMON MISTAKE: If fileName is still the typed 'receipt.jpg' left from the camera shortcut, the server reads .jpg and saves a .jpg. Fix: send mimeType=application/pdf, OR set fileName to the real FileName chip (which ends in .pdf).

This is purely a shortcut/JSON fix - you do NOT need to redeploy the web app for it.

Part 4 - Test it & final checklist

8 Test the shortcut

- Run the shortcut and pick a PDF receipt.
- Expect a response like: `{"ok":true,"message":"Receipt logged."}`
- Open the Google Sheet: a new row should appear.
- Click the Image Link - it should open a .pdf (not a .jpg).

9 Final checklist

- ☐ Shortcut renamed to 'Log Receipt (Choose File)'
- ☐ Take Photo deleted; Select File added (Multiple: Off)
- ☐ Set Variable ReceiptFile = Selected File (the file, not the name)
- ☐ Base64 Encode input = ReceiptFile, Line Breaks: None
- ☐ Get Details of Files (Name) + Set Variable FileName
- ☐ JSON: imageBase64 = Base64 chip, fileName = FileName chip
- ☐ JSON: mimeType = application/pdf (or fileName ends in .pdf)
- ☐ Tested with a real PDF; Image Link opens a .pdf

WATCH OUT: If you ever edit the Apps Script code, you **MUST** redeploy a **NEW** version (Deploy -> Manage deployments -> Edit -> New version). The /exec URL stays the same, so the shortcut needs no change.

More detail lives in `ios-shortcut/SHORTCUT_SETUP.md` and `LESSONS_LEARNED.md` in the repo.